Metropolitan Learning Center Mascot



PORTLAND
Public Schools

May 12, 2026

Background and Rationale for a Mascot

- Metropolitan Learning Center (MLC) is an alternative school in Portland that draws on the city's diversity and resources to create a challenging, student-centered learning environment.
- MLC honors students' identities, strengths, and learning styles, fostering authenticity, belonging, and community.
- The school's core values—**courage, compassion, respect, self-discipline, and integrity**—guide both learning and behavior.
- Strong relationships and a shared sense of purpose are central to MLC's mission.
- A school mascot would support this mission by reinforcing identity, unity, and belonging within the MLC community.

Engagement Timeline and Process

- October 2024 - Request for mascot
- April 2025 - Mascot Committee created and community survey released
- May 2025 - Committee reviewed submissions and narrowed options for a community vote
- May/June 2025 - Committee reviews community mascot votes and makes a recommendation

Why the Monarch Butterfly?

A caterpillar turning into a butterfly is a great visual that represents the growth and transformation which takes place for the students at MLC.

Thank you!

Guiding Principles

"Mascots are often a nod to the spirit of the institution, its physical location, its history or an important aspect of its culture."

- Core values of school
- What are key traits or attributes you find in students and staff at the school?
- Animals/roles native to Portland
- Attributes or roles integral to the school
- Demonstrate open communication, honesty, integrity, and transparency
- Center students voices and participation along with the support and participation of staff, community members and alumni

Character Traits and Values

Courage
Compassion
Self Discipline
Respect
Integrity
Community
Experiential
JOY!